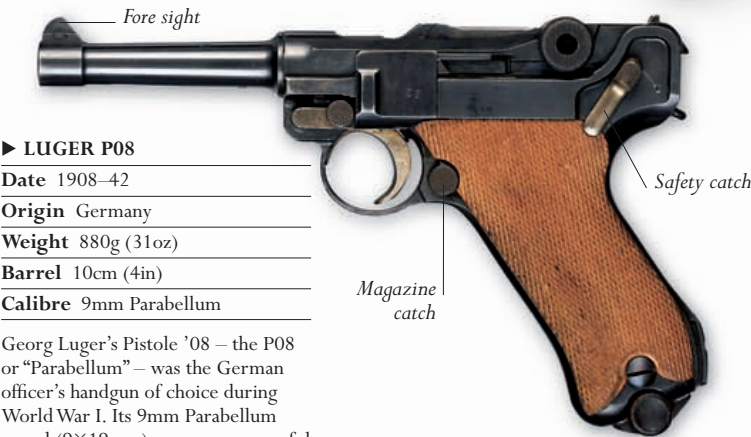


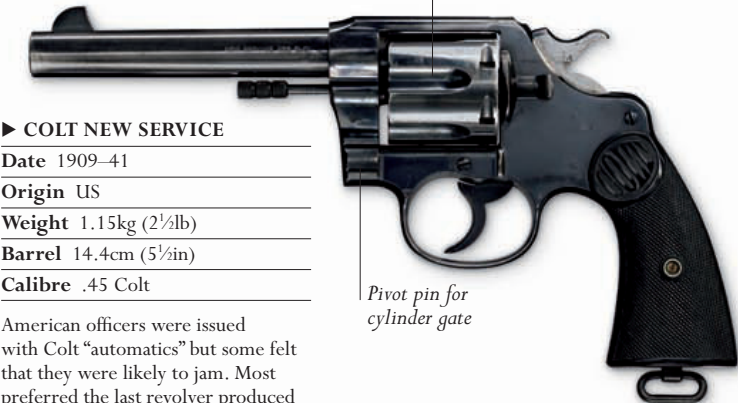
TRENCH-FIGHTING WEAPONS

Throughout World War I, assaults on enemy positions almost inevitably ended in hand-to-hand combat in the confined spaces of trenches and dugouts. Pistols came into their own in such circumstances, but were issued mainly to officers. Individual soldiers armed themselves with the rifle-and-bayonet as well as expedient weapons such as knives and axes, which were chosen for their ability to disable or kill at a single stroke. The design of early grenades, though not entirely satisfactory, soon improved dramatically.



► **LUGER P08**
Date 1908-42
Origin Germany
Weight 880g (31oz)
Barrel 10cm (4in)
Calibre 9mm Parabellum

Georg Luger's Pistole '08 – the P08 or “Parabellum” – was the German officer's handgun of choice during World War I. Its 9mm Parabellum round (9×19mm) was more powerful than others of similar dimensions, and became a world standard.



► **COLT NEW SERVICE**
Date 1909-41
Origin US
Weight 1.15kg (2½lb)
Barrel 14.4cm (5½in)
Calibre .45 Colt

American officers were issued with Colt “automatics” but some felt that they were likely to jam. Most preferred the last revolver produced for the US Army – the .45-calibre Colt New Service.



► **WEBLEY & SCOTT MK VI**
Date 1915
Origin UK
Weight 1.05kg (2¼lb)
Barrel 15.2cm (6in)
Calibre .455 Eley

Birmingham arms manufacturer Webley & Scott began supplying pistols to the British Army in 1887. The Mk VI was the last of them, and was prized for its rugged reliability.



▼ **STICK GRENADE**
Date 1915
Origin Germany
Weight 595g (21oz)
Length 36.5cm (14¼in)

The *Stielhandgranate* first saw service with German troops, and became one of the Stormtroopers' iconic weapons. The handle gave the thrower a significant range advantage over one armed with grenades such as the Mills bomb.



▼ **SMLE MKIII RIFLE WITH WIRE-CUTTING ATTACHMENT**
Date 1907
Origin UK
Weight 3.7kg (8lb)
Barrel 64cm (25in)
Calibre .303in

The battlefields of World War I were festooned with barbed-wire entanglements, and many methods for dealing with this were tested. One involved fitting sprung cutting jaws to the muzzle of an SMLE rifle, but this proved ineffective.



► **TRENCH AXE**
Date 1916
Origin UK

Issued to British troops as a general-purpose tool, the trench axe was widely employed as a weapon in close-quarter fighting during raids and assaults on enemy positions.